

Why Gardens is the problem child, and what we are doing about it

Three resorts, one brand, three very different organic health stories. Gardens is not short on visitors. It is short on the right visitors and the booking. Here is the gap, the cause, and the plan.

Team briefing · June 2026 · Source: Google Analytics, Search Console, Google Business Profile, Semrush (last 90 days)

The scoreboard

Same brand, same Arenal location, same booking engine. Yet organic search earns wildly different amounts across the three properties.

PROPERTY	ORGANIC REVENUE (90 DAYS)	ORGANIC VISITORS (90 DAYS)	ORGANIC HEALTH
Tented	\$867,140	~21,750	HEALTHY
Springs	\$342,576	~19,390	HEALTHY
Gardens	\$53,402	~15,020	

PROPERTY

ORGANIC REVENUE (90
DAYS)

ORGANIC VISITORS (90
DAYS)

ORGANIC
HEALTH

PROBLEM
CHILD

The headline: **Gardens gets roughly the same organic traffic as its siblings but earns about one sixth of the organic revenue.** In fact, across the wider web Gardens pulls more total organic traffic than Springs or Tented. The problem is not awareness. It is that the traffic is the wrong fit and the booking does not happen.

Why Springs and Tented are healthy (the contrast)

Seeing why the other two work makes Gardens' problem obvious: they are understood correctly, so they attract the right guest and convert.

Nayara Tented Camp

Clearly understood as luxury glamping. It owns the glamping and safari searches, its organic converts, and it is even our strongest social account (90-day Instagram reach of 143,773, three to four times the other property handles). The story matches the product, so it travels.

Nayara Springs

Clearly understood as adults-only romance. It owns honeymoon, adults-only, and the MICHELIN Key prestige searches, and search engines and AI assistants describe it correctly. Organic earns over \$340,000 in 90 days. It is healthy and stays on maintenance.

The pattern: when the story matches the property, organic works. Gardens is the one place where the story does not match the property.

The diagnosis: Gardens is told as the wrong kind of hotel

Gardens is our family flagship: suites that sleep four, a sloth trail, kids' programming. But almost nobody, including Google and the AI assistants, is told that.

- **Its own page calls it the wrong thing.** The live page title is "Luxury Hotel in La Fortuna," not a family resort. The most important on-page signal points away from family.
- **The audience is already family.** Gardens' visitors are 60.8% female, ages 25 to 44, US and UK led. That is the family and multi-generational traveler, not the honeymoon couple.
- **AI answers leave Gardens out.** Ask an assistant for the best family resort in Costa Rica, or the best hot springs resort in Arenal, and Gardens does not appear at all. Worse, outside review pages actively describe it as a couples and honeymoon property.
- **It is cut off from its own history.** Gardens was renamed (it still shows as "Arenal Nayara" and "Nayara Resort Spa & Gardens" in places), and its reviews and awards are not fully connected to today's name. Some are even credited to Springs.

- **And it is slipping.** Gardens' organic traffic share has fallen from the high twenties and thirties (2023) to the mid teens, and estimated organic traffic is down about 37% since December.

Net: Gardens draws the visitors but loses the booking, because the people who would book it as a family resort cannot tell that is what it is, and the people it does attract are looking for something else.

The four root causes

1. Positioning

Gardens is presented as generic luxury or romance instead of the family flagship. This is the core error; it shapes everything else.

2. Missing pages and structure

There is no dedicated family page, and no Hotel, FAQ, or rating structured data that search engines and AI assistants read to understand and quote the property.

3. Entity disconnection

The old names ("Arenal Nayara" and "Nayara Resort Spa & Gardens"), the 4.9 rating from 1,070 reviews, and the awards are not yet unified under "Nayara Gardens," so the brand's own reputation is not fully working for it. Two parts of this are already moving: the Google Maps and Business Profile name is now corrected to Nayara Gardens, and

we are actively contacting the third-party sites that still show the old name to update them.

4. Measurement

This is now resolved at the source: Gardens' Search Console is connected to our reporting, so for the first time we can size family demand and baseline progress. The remaining gap is on-page structure, which is being addressed (see below).

What we are going to do about it

A focused, sequenced plan for Gardens organic. We do not need more analysis; we need these shipped and measured. Springs and Tented stay on maintenance.

Already in motion. This is not a cold start. The Google Maps and Business Profile name change to Nayara Gardens is live. Gardens Search Console is now connected for measurement. The page FAQ, structure, and schema fixes are in progress this week. And we are actively reaching out to the third-party sites that still show the old name. The remaining items below build on that momentum.

FOUNDATION



Connect Gardens Search Console so we can size family demand and prove progress.

DONE

Owner: analytics / dev

2

Fix the Gardens page FAQ, structure, and schema (Hotel, FAQ, and rating data with the old names, the 4.9 / 1,070 rating, and awards), so search and AI understand and quote Gardens correctly. **IN PROGRESS** Owner: web / SEO

3

Rewrite the live Gardens page to lead with family (title, H1, meta, intro). The cheapest high-leverage fix; fold into the structure work underway. **IN PROGRESS** Owner: web / content

BUILD THE WINNABLE PAGES

1

Build the Gardens family page targeting the family searches (costa rica family resorts and similar), with verified proof points: suites sleep four, sloth trail, babysitting, on-call doctor, guaranteed adjacent rooms. **NEXT** Owner: content / web

2

Build the Arenal / La Fortuna page targeting "hotels in la fortuna costa rica" (the single most winnable mid-volume term), positioning all three properties. **NEXT**

Owner: content / web

3

Publish Gardens dining content and add menus to Google Business Profile. "Restaurants" is the top non-brand Maps search for Gardens (3,543 in 90 days) and dining is open white space in Arenal. **NEXT** Owner: content / local

4

Build the sloth experience page, credited to Gardens. Reclaims the "hotel with sloths" answer we currently lose, and corrects the drift that credits the sloths to Springs.

NEXT Owner: content

AMPLIFY OFF-PAGE

1

Correct the old name across third-party sites. Actively contacting every site that still shows "Arenal Nayara" or the old name so the record matches today's brand.

IN PROGRESS Owner: PR / partnerships

2

Get Gardens into the family round-ups that own those answers today, and refresh our inclusion in the Condé Nast and Travel + Leisure lists using our award relationships, with the family positioning leading.

NEXT Owner: PR / partnerships

How we will know it worked

Every step above is measured against a clean baseline, not assumed. This keeps the work honest and defensible.

- **Baseline now:** Search Console is connected, so we capture Gardens' starting family-term rankings and organic revenue as the line we measure against.
- **Leading signs (weeks):** Gardens starts appearing for family searches and in AI answers for "best family resort Costa Rica"; the live page reads as family; the old name fades from third-party listings.
- **The result that matters (months):** Gardens organic revenue closes the gap toward its siblings, from roughly one sixth of Springs today toward parity for its share of visitors.

One honest note: family demand is hard to size precisely because Gardens has barely appeared for it until now. With Search Console connected we will confirm the volume with Keyword Planner, and treat the new pages as tests we prove, not promises.

Report 1 of 5 in the Nayara digital strategy series. Next: the Journal, Google Business Profile, social, and paid. Figures are from live analytics for the stated period; recommendations are framed as steps to ship and measure, not completed work.